

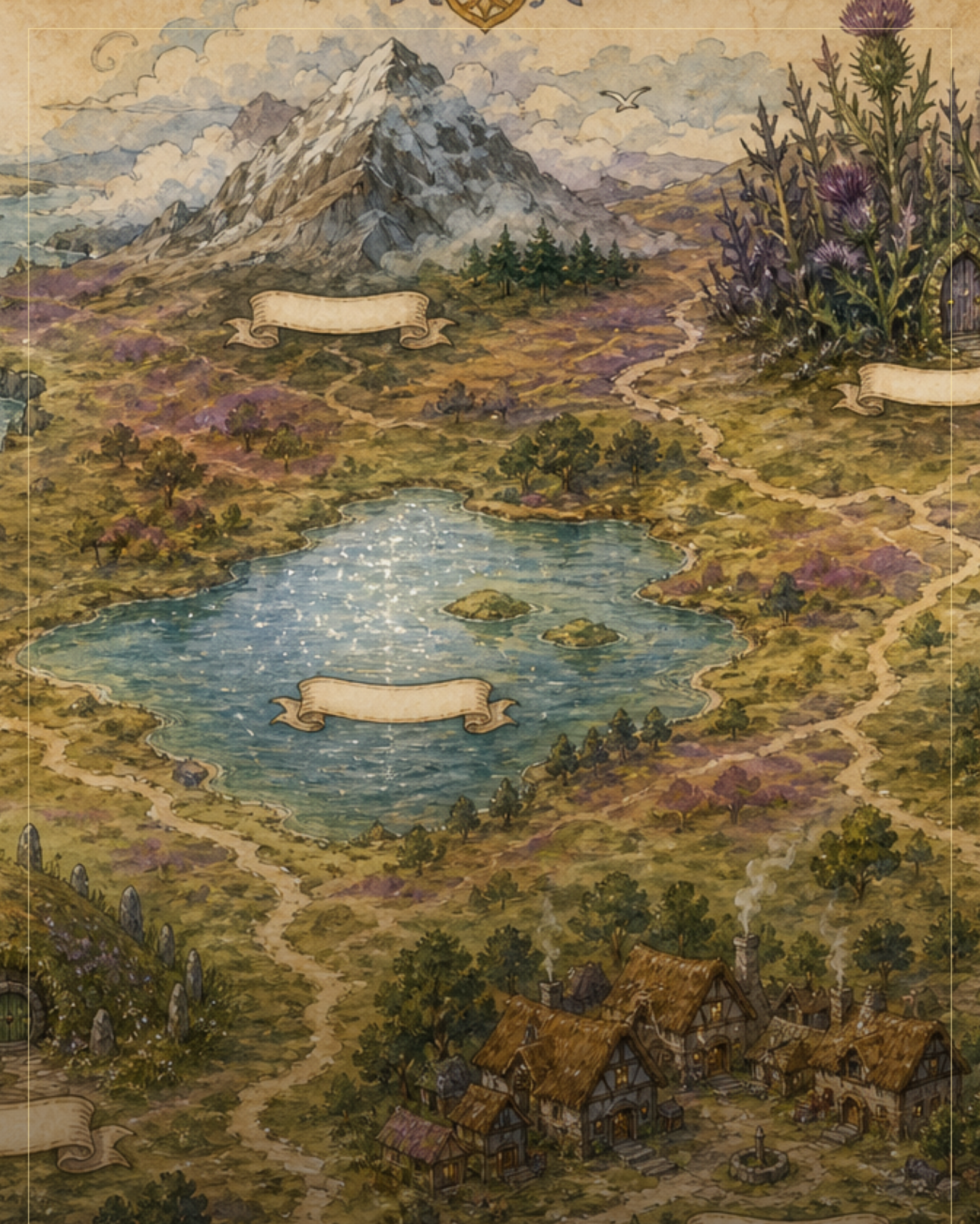
The background of the entire page is a rich, hand-painted fantasy map. It depicts a lush landscape with a winding river that flows from the top left towards the bottom right. The river is a vibrant blue, with small islands and rocky outcrops. The surrounding land is a mix of green and purple hues, suggesting different types of vegetation or magical terrain. In the bottom right corner, there is a small village with several stone houses featuring thatched roofs. Smoke is rising from the chimneys, and a small stone well is visible in the foreground. The map is framed by a thin gold border, and there are several blank, scroll-like banners placed across the landscape, likely for names or descriptions. At the very top, a small portion of a crest or shield is visible.

ADVENTURES IN ALBA

Adventure Module — Five linked one-shots with maps, read-alouds, encounters, treasure, and scaling

ADVENTURES IN ALBA

Scottish fairy myth, classic fantasy adventure, gentle danger, and table rules made for brave Adventurers.



THE BELLS OF ALBA

A five-part starter campaign across lochs, hills, cottages, fairy mounds, and a stormy thorn crown.



ADVENTURE MAP SPREAD

Use this map for village, keep, loch shrine, fairy mound, cave, and watchtower scenes.



BORDER THREAT MAP

Use this map when Redcloak patrols, Norse longships, storm-clans, or monsters enter the campaign.

How to run these adventures

Session recipe

- Read the boxed opening.
- Ask what the adventurers notice.
- Run two scenes and one creature moment.
- Give treasure that changes the next scene.
- End with a friend, promise, or map mark.

Length: each adventure is built for 30–45 minutes.

DM checklist

- Circle one feeling: scared, proud, lonely, sleepy, worried.
- Underline one clue the heroes can touch.
- Pick one NPC voice: whispery, grand, grumpy, giggly.
- Choose one safe cost before rolling: noise, mud, delay, lost hat.

Scaling

Group	Change
1 adventurer	Reduce enemy HP by 4 and MP by 2.
2–3 adventurers	Use listed stats.
4+ adventurers	Add one clue objective or +3 HP to the main creature.
Older Adventurers	Add a timer, locked door, or rival helper.

Quick rewards

1	Helpful map mark
2	1d6 copper
3	Friendly promise
4	Consumable charm

1. THE BELL-ROOT PATH

Read aloud: Tiny bells hang from sleepy roots. A fox dreams beside a moon-rune door, and the path is holding its breath.

Scenes

- Notice the bells before they ring.
- Find the silver acorn key.
- Wake the fox kindly or sneak past.

Main creature

Redcap Bramble Sneak, DR 3, wants its shiny bell back.

Checks

Approach	Stat	Wobble
Careful movement	Agility	Noise, snag, or muddy boot.
Read signs/runes	Int	Right answer, awkward timing.
Comfort or negotiate	Wis	Creature asks for proof.
Hold, lift, protect	Strength	You help, but lose 1 HP.
Fairy chance	Luck	Magic works with a funny mark.

Treasure

Silver acorn key; 6 copper; fox promise.

Read-aloud closer

Ask each adventurer what their hero looks like at the end of the scene: muddy boots, proud smile, glowing pocket, or new friend.

If they get stuck

Show one clue in the art, have an NPC ask a simple question, or let a pet notice the safest path.

Optional twist

A rival helper arrives, the weather changes, or the treasure points to the next map mark.

Level note

After a big kindness, mark one star toward the next level.

2. THE GLASS LOCH

Read aloud: The loch is clear as a window. Something long and blue coils below, guarding a bridge made of moon-reflection.

Scenes

- Gather three dry stones.
- Convince the Glass Loch Serpent the party is not stealing moonlight.
- Cross without waking the cold current.

Main creature

Glass Loch Serpent, DR 5, uses Mirror Wave.

Checks

Approach	Stat	Wobble
Careful movement	Agility	Noise, snag, or muddy boot.
Read signs/runes	Int	Right answer, awkward timing.
Comfort or negotiate	Wis	Creature asks for proof.
Hold, lift, protect	Strength	You help, but lose 1 HP.
Fairy chance	Luck	Magic works with a funny mark.

Treasure

Moon-water vial; 1 silver; safe crossing song.

Read-aloud closer

Ask each adventurer what their hero looks like at the end of the scene: muddy boots, proud smile, glowing pocket, or new friend.

If they get stuck

Show one clue in the art, have an NPC ask a simple question, or let a pet notice the safest path.

Optional twist

A rival helper arrives, the weather changes, or the treasure points to the next map mark.

Level note

After a big kindness, mark one star toward the next level.

3. THE SOOTY CHIMNEY

Read aloud: A cottage coughs black sparkles. Every spoon is missing, and the chimney giggles.

Scenes

- Climb or talk to the chimney.
- Sort useful soot from imp tricks.
- Return the spoon chorus before dinner.

Main creature

Soot Chimney Imp, DR 3, casts Soot Puff.

Checks

Approach	Stat	Wobble
Careful movement	Agility	Noise, snag, or muddy boot.
Read signs/runes	Int	Right answer, awkward timing.
Comfort or negotiate	Wis	Creature asks for proof.
Hold, lift, protect	Strength	You help, but lose 1 HP.
Fairy chance	Luck	Magic works with a funny mark.

Treasure

Warm oatcakes; soot chalk; 8 copper.

Read-aloud closer

Ask each adventurer what their hero looks like at the end of the scene: muddy boots, proud smile, glowing pocket, or new friend.

If they get stuck

Show one clue in the art, have an NPC ask a simple question, or let a pet notice the safest path.

Optional twist

A rival helper arrives, the weather changes, or the treasure points to the next map mark.

Level note

After a big kindness, mark one star toward the next level.

4. THE HOLLOW HILL WARNING

Read aloud: A ribbon of cold wind circles the mound. The Banshee is crying names no one remembers.

Scenes

- Listen inside the wail.
- Find the forgotten promise stone.
- Choose whether to open the fairy door.

Main creature

Hollow Hill Banshee, DR 6, uses Warning Wail.

Checks

Approach	Stat	Wobble
Careful movement	Agility	Noise, snag, or muddy boot.
Read signs/runes	Int	Right answer, awkward timing.
Comfort or negotiate	Wis	Creature asks for proof.
Hold, lift, protect	Strength	You help, but lose 1 HP.
Fairy chance	Luck	Magic works with a funny mark.

Treasure

Promise stone; 1 gold; ghost door favor.

Read-aloud closer

Ask each adventurer what their hero looks like at the end of the scene: muddy boots, proud smile, glowing pocket, or new friend.

If they get stuck

Show one clue in the art, have an NPC ask a simple question, or let a pet notice the safest path.

Optional twist

A rival helper arrives, the weather changes, or the treasure points to the next map mark.

Level note

After a big kindness, mark one star toward the next level.

5. THE THORN CROWN STORM

Read aloud: The hill giant kneels under thunder. Its crown is too tight, and every thorn points at the village.

Scenes

- Survive stormy brambles.
- Learn the giant is in pain.
- Remove the thorn crown using teamwork and ritual magic.

Main creature

Thorn Crown Giant, DR 7, phase change at half HP.

Checks

Approach	Stat	Wobble
Careful movement	Agility	Noise, snag, or muddy boot.
Read signs/runes	Int	Right answer, awkward timing.
Comfort or negotiate	Wis	Creature asks for proof.
Hold, lift, protect	Strength	You help, but lose 1 HP.
Fairy chance	Luck	Magic works with a funny mark.

Treasure

Mythral thorn seed; village feast; level-up feat.

Read-aloud closer

Ask each adventurer what their hero looks like at the end of the scene: muddy boots, proud smile, glowing pocket, or new friend.

If they get stuck

Show one clue in the art, have an NPC ask a simple question, or let a pet notice the safest path.

Optional twist

A rival helper arrives, the weather changes, or the treasure points to the next map mark.

Level note

After a big kindness, mark one star toward the next level.

CAMPAIGN TRACKER

Use this tracker to connect every one-shot to the larger war for Alba. Add map marks, faction reputation, and which monster became an ally.

Adventure	Friend made	Treasure	Promise
Bell-Root Path			
Glass Loch			
Sooty Chimney			
Hollow Hill			
Thorn Crown Storm			

Leveling suggestion: level up after adventures 2 and 5. Award a feat after adventure 5 if the party reaches level 4.